

1. Customers would be interested enough in the social network to sign up. (Registration)
2. Votizen would be able to verify them as registered voters. (Activation)
3. Customers who were verified voters would engage with the site's activism tools over time. (Retention)
4. Engaged customers would tell their friends about the service and recruit them into civic causes. (Referral)

Three months and \$1,200 later, David's first MVP was in customers' hands. In the initial cohorts, 5 percent signed up for the service and 17 percent verified their registered voter status (see the chart below). The numbers were so low that there wasn't enough data to tell what sort of engagement or referral would occur. It was time to start iterating.

	INITIAL MVP
Registration	5%
Activation	17%
Retention	Too low
Referral	Too low

David spent the next two months and another \$5,000 split testing new product features, messaging, and improving the product's design to make it easier to use. Those tests showed dramatic improvements, going from a 5 percent registration rate to 17 percent and from a 17 percent activation rate to over 90 percent. Such is the power of split testing. This optimization gave David a critical mass of customers with which to measure the next two leaps of faith. However, as shown in the chart below, those numbers proved to be even more discouraging: David achieved a referral rate of only 4 percent and a retention rate of 5 percent.